

Find your purpose in the Synthetic Era

*Post-work vocation, reinvention by decades, agnostic spirituality and personal manifesto
in the transition to Industry 6.0*



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Mayo 2026 - CC-BY-4.0

RESUMEN

I believe we are living the greatest crisis of purpose since the 20th century. My thesis: the **Synthetic Era**—that moment where AI does much of the cognitive and creative work—returns to the human being an ancient and forgotten question: *what am I here for?* This whitepaper articulates my operational framework for finding purpose when work ceases to be its main source. I reformulate the notion of vocation as **sustained contribution**, propose reinvention by decades, explore **agnostic spirituality** as a lay practice, situate community as an irreplaceable source of meaning, and deliver a method to write your **personal manifesto**. From the **Qualitas Doctrine**: purpose is not delegated to AI. AI can assist you in articulating it, but only you can decide what you live for.

Palabras clave: Purpose - Synthetic Era - Vocation - Reinvention - Agnostic spirituality - Community - Qualitas Doctrine - Personal manifesto - Chris Meniw - Meaning

"The urgent question of the 21st century is not what you will do when AI can do your work. It is what you will do with the life you have left when nothing forces you to work anymore."

— Chris Meniw

1. Introduction — the greatest crisis of purpose since the 20th century

I believe, after thousands of conversations with professionals in transition across LATAM, that we are living the greatest crisis of purpose since the mid-20th century. The reason is structural: for seventy years, work was the main source of identity, meaning and social contribution. The **Synthetic Era** is dissolving that equation. When AI can do most of the cognitive and creative work, what do we humans do?

The easy answer — "reinvent yourself" — hides the real question. It is not just about learning new skills. It is about reformulating what we are alive for. My thesis is direct: in the Synthetic Era, purpose ceases to be inherited from the job and must be deliberately constructed, decade by decade, by each human being. Those who do not construct it, suffer it.

2. Crisis of purpose in the Synthetic Era

Three symptoms indicate someone is in a purpose crisis in the Synthetic Era. **Symptom 1 — Sunday apathy:** Sunday afternoon becomes intolerable. Not because of the imminent work Monday, but because the void of meaning becomes loud when there is no activity to cover it. **Symptom 2 — compulsive need for novelty:** permanent consumption of news, social networks, content. Novelty anaesthetises the void without filling it. **Symptom 3 — inability to explain why you do what you do:** if asked "what for?" three times in a row, at some point you run out of answer.

I believe these three symptoms will affect the majority of the economically active population of LATAM in the next five years. It is not an individual crisis: it is a civilisational crisis. And like every crisis, it contains an opportunity: to return to asking the most basic question.

3. From vocation to contribution

I do not believe in the romantic concept of vocation —that idea that each person was born for one thing they must discover. I find it reductionist and the source of much frustration. I propose substituting it with a more operational concept: **sustained contribution**.

Sustained contribution means: identifying which concrete problem of the world outrages or excites you enough to want to work on it for several years, which unique capacities of yours can bring real value on that problem, and building a regular practice around that. Contribution is not a fixed destination: it is a renewable commitment. You can contribute different things in different stages of your life. What matters is that in each stage there exists a conscious, articulated and sustained contribution. Without contribution, there is no purpose —only prolonged entertainment.

4. Reinventing yourself every decade

My thesis on reinvention is direct: in the Synthetic Era, every professional must reinvent themselves every decade. Not due to technological demand —though also—, but out of existential necessity. A professional identity sustained for forty years without reinvention produces rigidity, resentment and late crisis.

I propose four typical reinventions over the course of an adult life. **Decade 20-30:** broad exploration, formative errors, construction of base craft. **Decade 30-40:** vertical deepening, public contribution, family or project formation. **Decade 40-50:** horizontal expansion, mentorship, controlled risk. **Decade 50+:** synthesis, transmission, civic contribution. Each reinvention does not annul the previous one: it integrates it. The 60-year-old person is the sum of their four previous versions, not their negation.

5. Agnostic spirituality and purpose

I do not write from a specific religious tradition. I write from what I call **agnostic spirituality**: the humble recognition that there are dimensions of human experience that science describes but does not exhaust, and that deserve deliberate attention even if not attributed to a specific deity.

Agnostic spirituality as a practice includes: daily silence time, contemplation of nature, reading of wisdom texts from multiple traditions, ritualisation of great life moments (birth, death, transitions), and deliberate cultivation of gratitude. This practice does not require belief: it requires discipline. I believe in the Synthetic Era, where the material and the cognitive are automated, the spiritual—in a broad sense—rises in relative value. Those who cultivate it, prosper. Those who neglect it, empty themselves.

6. Community as a source of meaning

Western modernity sold us the lie of the self-sufficient individual. The Synthetic Era brutally refutes that lie: no human being finds sustained purpose in solitude. Purpose is always experienced in relation to others.

Five community practices I recommend cultivating deliberately. **(1) A purpose community:** regular group—religious, civic, professional—where you share a common commitment. **(2) A friendship community:** five to ten people you know deeply and who know you. **(3) A family community:** includes the biological family plus the chosen family. **(4) An intergenerational community:** people older and younger than you, not just peers. **(5) A service community:** where you contribute without receiving economic counter-benefit. Without these five layers, purpose becomes intellectual abstraction. With them, it becomes lived life.

7. Work, leisure and learning

In the Synthetic Era, the three classical categories—work, leisure, learning—reorganise. My thesis: we move from a linear model (study / work / retire) to a simultaneous model where the three categories coexist throughout life in variable proportions.

My operational recommendation for designing your balance: dedicate at least 30% of active time to **deliberate learning** (not informative, formative), between 40-50% to **meaningful work** (that produces value for others, not necessarily remunerated), and between 20-30% to **deep leisure** (rest, play, contemplation, not passive digital consumption). These percentages are not rigid. They are an invitation to audit how you distribute your real hours today and to redistribute them consciously. Whoever lives 80% of the time in remunerated work and passive digital consumption lives impoverished even if they earn well.

8. Your personal manifesto

I close with a concrete exercise: writing your **personal manifesto**. My recommendation: block three hours in solitude, without an agent, with paper and pencil. Answer in writing seven questions. **(1)** What problem of the world outrages or excites you enough to want to work on it for the next five years? **(2)** What unique capacities of yours can contribute to that problem? **(3)** Which five people are your purpose community? **(4)** What three spiritual or contemplative practices will you sustain daily? **(5)** What is your next reinvention—and when will you start it? **(6)** How do you want to be remembered by those who know you in depth? **(7)** If you had one year to live, what would you change from your current routine?

I believe that document, handwritten, reread every six months and adjusted when necessary, is worth more than any coaching course. It is your compass in the Synthetic Era. The **Qualitas Doctrine** I uphold culminates here: purpose is not delegated to AI, is not bought, is not inherited. It is written, sustained and renewed. That is the last human freedom, and no one can automate it for you.

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